



United Nations Office for the Coordination of Humanitarian Affairs (OCHA)
Regional Office for Asia Pacific (ROAP) · Bangkok · Thailand

What is data preparedness?

Poor info. management = Poor information

Poor information = Poor decisions

Planning Rapidly assess impact, needs and priorities; base programme decisions on knowledge.

Coordination Effectively use inter-agency resources with minimal gaps and overlaps

Monitoring Evaluate impact of assistance on an ongoing basis and adjust accordingly

What is data preparedness?

Data preparedness means that a minimum set of information standards, tools, sources, actors, forums and platforms are in place to enable effective and immediate information management in the event of an emergency.

How do we do this?

Systematic planning and coordination can take place in the immediate aftermath of an emergency only when a framework exists for systematic information management

Institutional support

IM resources

culture of sharing

data standards

baseline data

common systems

Two recent examples

Oct 8 2005 **7.6** earthquake strikes northern Pakistan, killing over 70,000 people and injuring up to 100,000

May 27 2006 **5.9** earthquake strikes central Java in Indonesia, killing some 5,700 people and injuring up to 40,000

Information needed in the first days

Casualties: How many fatalities, how many injuries?

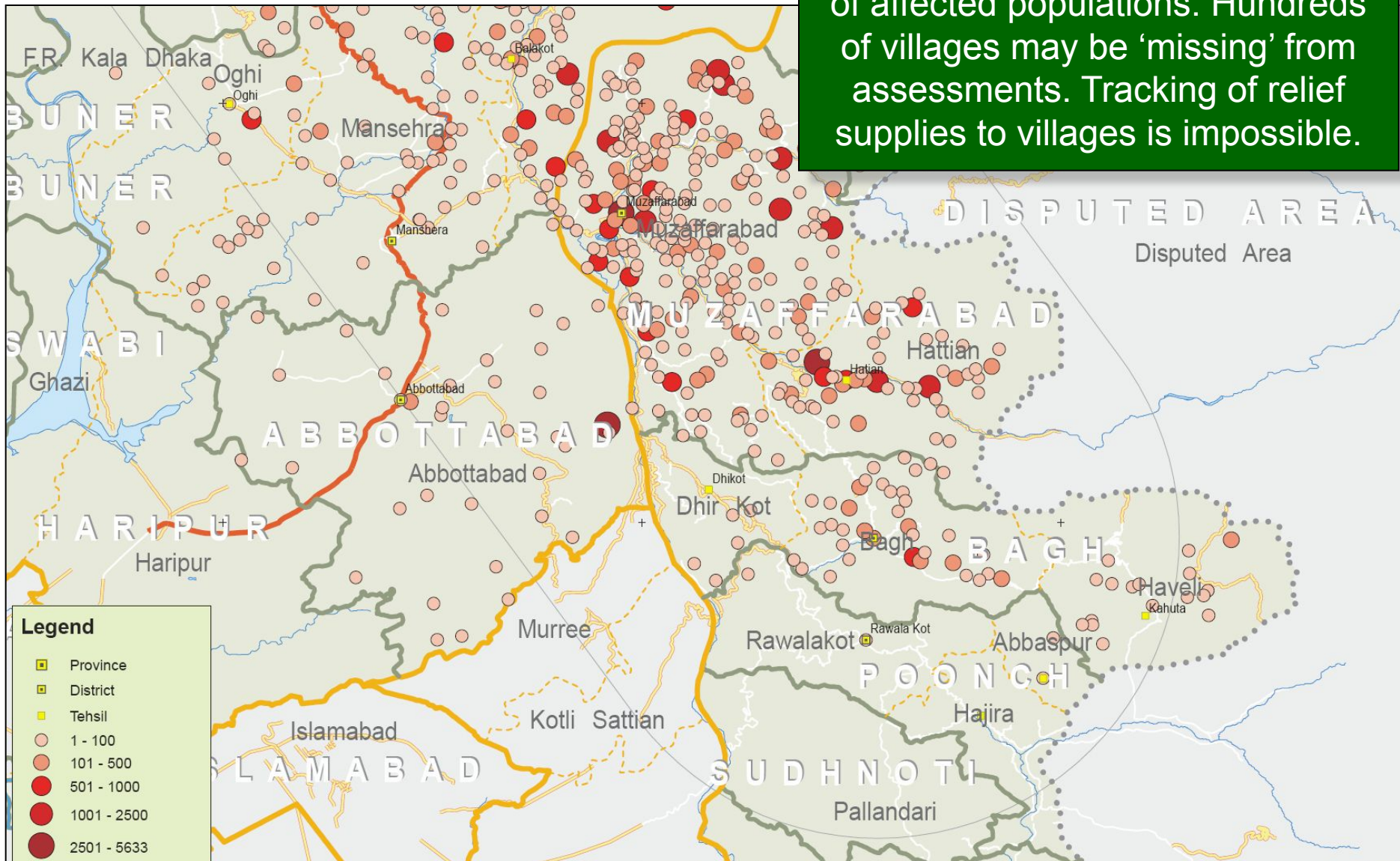
Shelter: How many houses destroyed and damaged, where, how many homeless, what materials are needed and in what quantities, where are the priorities?

Services: Status of health facilities, disease outbreaks, availability of water and sanitation, status of schools?

Logistics: Warehouse locations, road conditions, bottlenecks, air transport?

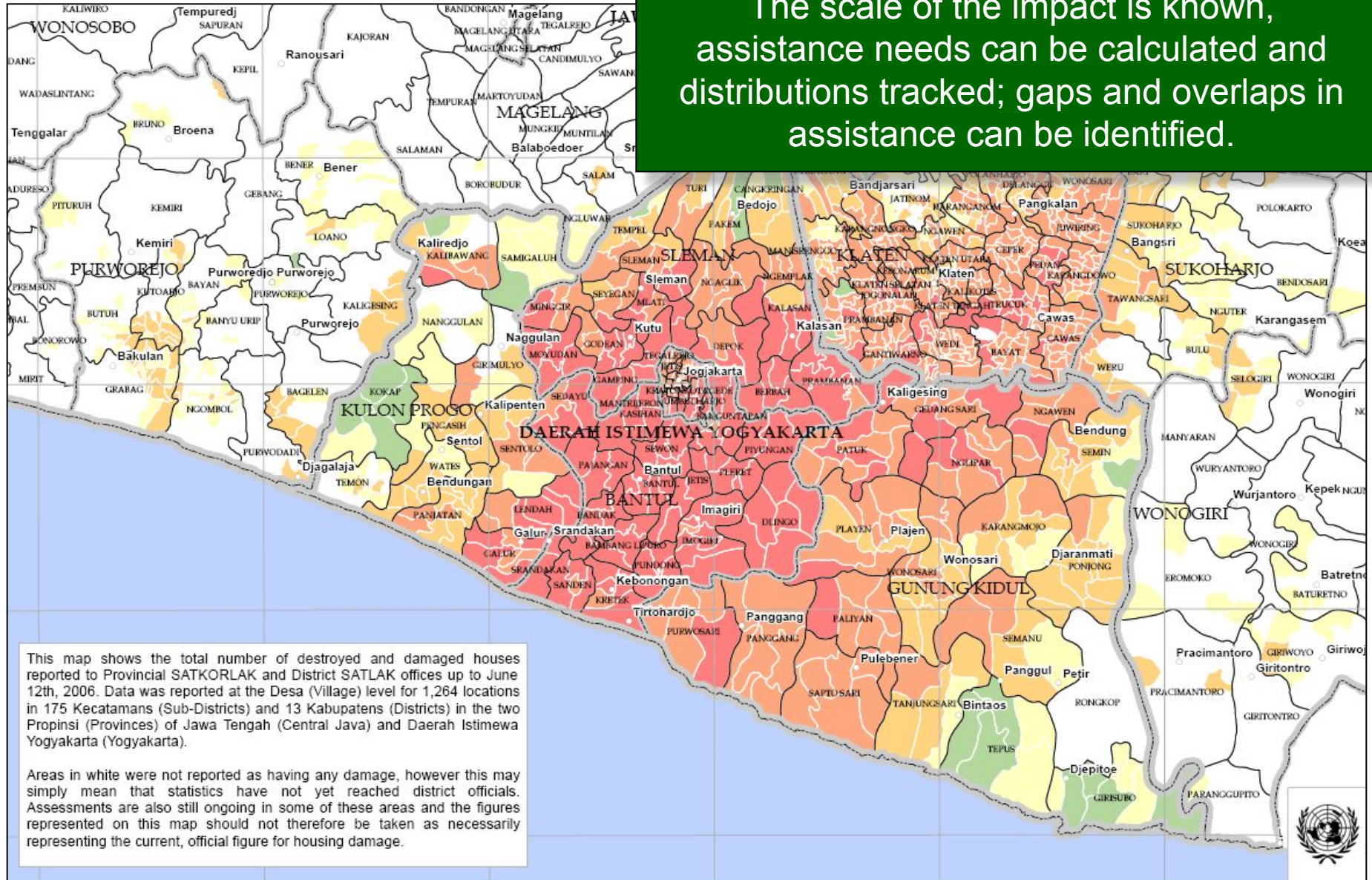
Pakistan day 150

Five months after the earthquake there is still an incomplete picture of affected populations. Hundreds of villages may be 'missing' from assessments. Tracking of relief supplies to villages is impossible.



Indonesia day 15

Two weeks after the earthquake a complete village by village assessment is available. The scale of the impact is known, assistance needs can be calculated and distributions tracked; gaps and overlaps in assistance can be identified.



Indonesia day 18

Location			Population				House Damage					Shelter Distribution						
PROVINCE / PROPINSI	DISTRICT / KABUPATEN	SUB-DISTRICT / KECAMATAN	Total Population (Bakornas)	% Below Poverty Line (GOI Vulnerability Data)	Total Number of Families (Bakornas)	Average Family Size	Number houses destroyed or heavily damaged	Total Houses damaged	% of Families w dest or heavily dam houses	Affected Population (Destroyed or heavy damaged)	Affected Population (All damaged houses)	Baseline Need for Emergency Shelter	Tents Delivered	Tarpaulines Delivered	Coverage with Tents and Tarpaulins	Remaining Tarp/Tent Need	Number Cleanup Toolkits Delivered (CUT)	Number of Self Helt Emergency Repair Kits Delivered (SHERT)
			See note 1				See note 2					See note 3	See note 4	See note 4	See note 8	See note 3		
Yogyakarta	Bantul	Bambang Lipuro	43,106	8.3%	9,964	4.3	9,319	10,135	93.5%	40,316	43,846	9,319	231	524	8.1%	8,564		
		Banguntapan	79,452	8.9%	21,379	3.7	13,789	21,241	64.5%	51,245	78,939	13,789	0	2,846	20.6%	10,943		
		Bantul	58,893	6.6%	14,799	4.0	12,046	15,347	81.4%	47,937	61,074	12,046	8	562	4.7%	11,476		
		Dlingo	37,050	12.1%	9,889	3.7	4,757	9,477	48.1%	17,823	35,506	4,757	56	3,704	79.0%	997		
		Imogiri	56,983	14.9%	15,258	3.7	11,017	15,488	72.2%	41,144	57,842	11,017	172	6,141	57.3%	4,704		
		Jetis	50,144	7.5%	14,046	3.6	13,966	14,630	99.4%	49,858	52,229	13,966	60	518	4.1%	13,388		
		Kasihnan	79,116	7.6%	22,463	3.5	6,447	18,550	28.7%	22,707	65,334	6,447	0	126	2.0%	6,321		
		Kretek	31,176	7.8%	8,519	3.7	5,786	8,272	67.9%	21,174	30,272	5,786	4	99	1.8%	5,683		
		Pajangan	30,422	10.5%	7,300	4.2	3,444	6,054	47.2%	14,353	25,229	3,444	0	0	0.0%	3,444		
		Pandak	48,593	14.1%	12,157	4.0	8,071	12,136	66.4%	32,261	48,509	8,071	14	38	0.6%	8,019		
		Piyungan	38,208	7.4%	10,289	3.7	10,315	13,450	100.3%	38,305	49,946	10,315	0	1,308	12.7%	9,007		
		Pleret	34,387	15.0%	10,505	3.3	10,461	11,899	99.6%	34,243	38,950	10,461	387	11,071	109.5%	-997		
		Pundong	28,424	9.6%	8,540	3.3	8,696	9,196	101.8%	28,943	30,607	8,696	573	1,116	19.4%	7,007		
		Sanden	34,123	3.0%	10,325	3.3	2,149	6,799	20.8%	7,102	22,470	2,149	0	0	0.0%	2,149		
		Sedayu	44,007	7.7%	9,534	4.6	2,043	6,634	21.4%	9,430	30,621	2,043	0	40	2.0%	2,003		
		Sewon	77,118	7.6%	21,532	3.6	16,777	22,781	77.9%	60,088	81,591	16,777	141	1,060	7.2%	15,576		
		Srandakan	29,367	10.2%	8,059	3.6	3,396	6,902	42.1%	12,375	25,151	3,396	0	10	0.3%	3,386		
		Bantul Unspecified											2,328	8,910				
		SUBTOTAL	800,569	9.1%	214,558	3.7	142,479	208,991	66.4%	531,624	778,118	142,479	3,974	38,073	29.5%	100,432		
	Gunung Kidul	Gedang Sari	40,388	16.4%	10,536	3.8	3,401	8,774	32.3%	13,037	33,634	3,401	0	99	2.9%	3,302		
		Girisubo	27,052	15.8%	6,471	4.2	2	7	0.0%	8	29	2	0	0	0.0%	2		
		Karangmojo	56,665	11.5%	13,215	4.3	104	492	0.8%	446	2,110	104	0	0	0.0%	104		
		Ngawen	36,194	11.5%	9,011	4.0	625	3,042	6.9%	2,510	12,219	625	0	15	2.4%	610		
		Nglipar	35,007	13.9%	8,318	4.2	1,882	5,306	22.6%	7,921	22,331	1,882	6	20	1.4%	1,856		
		Paliyan	30,874	17.6%	8,791	3.5	770	3,426	8.8%	2,704	12,032	770	0	325	42.2%	445		
		Panggang	28,253	16.7%	5,728	4.9	723	2,093	12.6%	3,566	10,324	723	15	1,577	220.2%	-869		
		Patuk	31,635	14.1%	9,078	3.5	6,494	10,477	71.5%	22,630	36,510	6,494	6	1,652	25.5%	4,836		
		Playen	60,090	9.7%	13,436	4.5	1,160	3,367	8.6%	5,188	15,058	1,160	2	484	41.9%	674		
		Ponjong	56,571	11.2%	11,875	4.8	225	537	1.9%	1,072	2,558	225	0	0	0.0%	225		
		Purwosari	19,878	16.4%	4,451	4.5	976	2,580	21.9%	4,359	11,522	976	0	120	12.3%	856		
		Rongkop	32,375	14.3%	7,010	4.6	0	0	0.0%	0	0	0	0	0	100.0%	0		
		Sapto Sari	36,766	14.5%	9,340	3.9	1,018									958		
		Semanu	58,379	11.2%	14,473	4.0	212									212		
		Semin	55,008	12.2%	11,783	4.7	157									157		
		Tanjungsari	27,712	14.9%	7,644	3.6	123									123		
		Tepus	36,709	12.2%	8,456	4.3	0									0		
		Wonosari	78,226	10.8%	19,320	4.0	446									446		
		Gunung Kidul unspecified														-1		
		SUBTOTAL	747,782	12.7%	178,936	4.2	18,318									13,936		

Data standards such as ‘pcodes’ provide the framework to systematically compile data, model needs, track agency coverage and monitor progress.

Why the difference?

Pakistan		Indonesia
weak	Institutional support	weak
weak	IM resources	weak
weak	culture of sharing	strong
weak	data standards	strong
weak	baseline data	strong
weak	common systems	strong

Indonesia was better prepared, and
there is still room for improvement

Why aren't we better prepared?

- IM (rather than IT) has poor institutional support in most UN agencies, is poorly resourced and not a priority for emergency deployments
- Availability of, and access to, essential data varies enormously by country, exacerbated by a common reluctance of people to freely share their knowledge
- IM is not an integral part of early warning and contingency planning

What can you do?

Be aware: If you recognize the importance of good information, recognize what it takes to get it

Assess: Facilitate a 'data readiness assessment' to catalogue essential systems, data, partners and mechanisms

Cooperate: Get IM onto agendas; establish a working group to identify and address gaps; establish local data custodians; sign access agreements with providers

Prepare: Establish essential IM resources; integrate IM into contingency plans & operations; prepare assessments & pre-position data

Resource: Secure sufficient resources; ensure capacity within the cluster system; treat preparedness as a live activity

Further information



Data Preparedness Concept Paper



Data Preparedness Overview Paper

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